RTT within 18 weeks

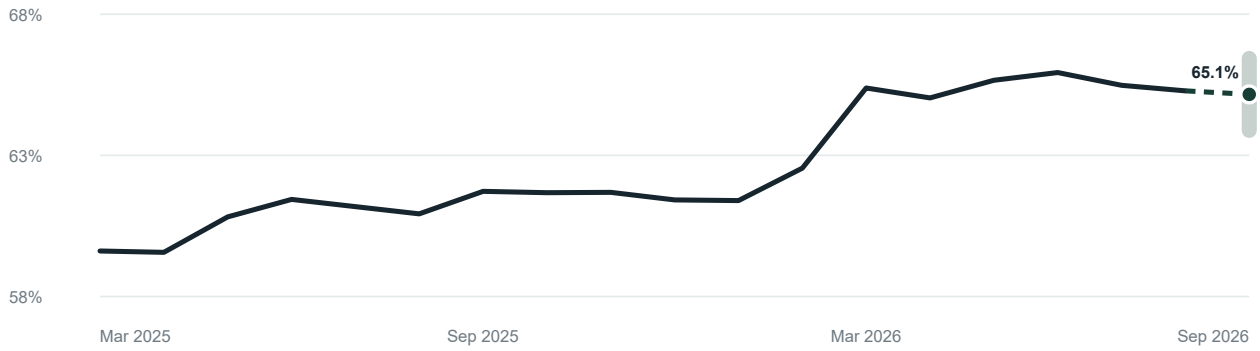
Forecast for September 2026 · data through August 2026

The latest RTT within 18 weeks result was 65.2%. For the next release, it is expected to remain broadly stable at 65.1%. Current-level seasonal and underlying-trend effects are small or offsetting, leaving the outlook broadly stable. The current projection is off course for 70% by March 2027. Across providers, sustained favourable signals outnumber adverse ones (74 to 12).

LATEST · AUGUST 2026	FORECAST · SEPTEMBER 2026	MAR 2027 TARGET OUTLOOK
65.2%	**65.1%**	Projected **66.2%**
0.5pp above forecast	80% expected range 63.9%–66.3%	Target **≥70%**
		7% Model-implied chance

Recent performance and next release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



Benchmark: 92% constitutional standard. 3.8pp below milestone

Data: NHS England referral to treatment waiting times. **Targets:** Medium Term Planning Framework national target · Medium Term Planning Framework final target

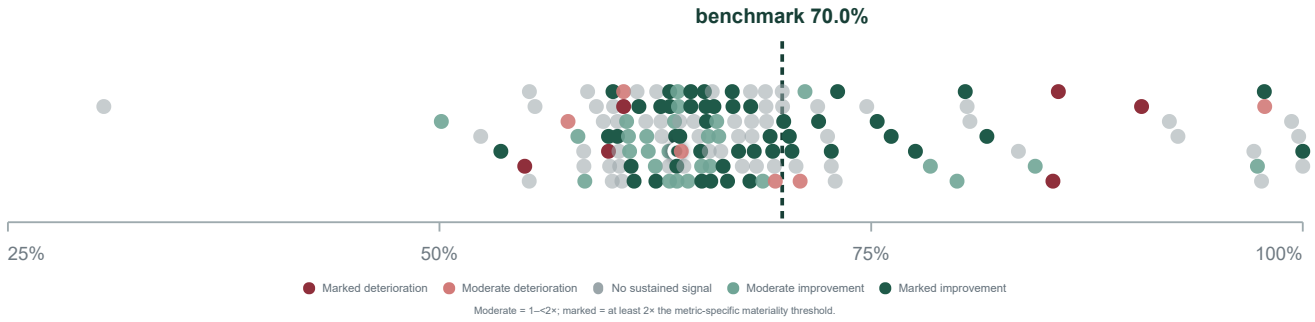
Method: Backtest-weighted ensemble of current-level seasonal movement, damped annual drift and a damped recent seasonal trend; at least 2 components are required. The final fit uses 229 consecutive months. Accuracy is tested on 36 rolling one-month-ahead forecasts. The 80% range uses empirical historical error quantiles from 24 forecast errors. Weights use inverse rolling RMSE and are shrunk toward equal weights. The pre-release commentary compares the current-level seasonal component with the combined forecast. Provider distribution and trajectory watch are shown on page 2.

RTT within 18 weeks

Distribution and trajectory watch · August 2026

Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.

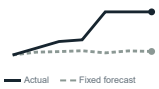


Trajectory watch

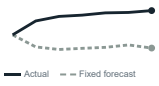
Six actual months are compared with one forecast path fixed before that window. Both lines begin at the same observed value. A low performer can be improving, while a high performer can be deteriorating. Status: Actual performance is compared with the monthly path forecast six months earlier. The displayed figure is the latest actual minus the fixed forecast for that same month; the six-month window checks persistence.

139	74	12	53
providers assessed	sustained favourable	sustained adverse	without an active signal

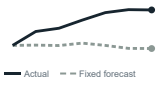
Largest sustained favourable moves

OXLEAS NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 100.0% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


48.1pp
LATEST MONTH: ABOVE FORECAST

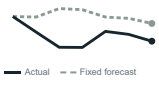
COUNTESS OF CHESTER HOSPITAL NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 68.4% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


15.2pp
LATEST MONTH: ABOVE FORECAST

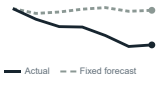
MID CHESHIRE HOSPITALS NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 70.6% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


14.5pp
LATEST MONTH: ABOVE FORECAST

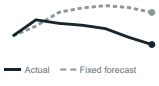
Largest sustained adverse moves

BRADFORD DISTRICT CARE NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 55.2% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


8.4pp
LATEST MONTH: BELOW FORECAST

HAMPSHIRE AND ISLE OF WIGHT HEALTHCARE NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 85.6% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


6.7pp
LATEST MONTH: BELOW FORECAST

UNIVERSITY HOSPITALS OF NORTH MIDLANDS NHS TRUST
Latest 60.0% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


6.2pp
LATEST MONTH: BELOW FORECAST

Trajectory-watch rule. Six actual months are compared with the corresponding path fixed before the six-month window. The displayed gap is the latest actual minus the fixed forecast for that same month. A signal requires a material latest-month gap and at least five of six months in that direction. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality.